

AI Invoice Reminder & Payment Tracker

An n8n pipeline that chases unpaid invoices automatically — scanning a ledger daily, drafting AI reminder emails at the right urgency, and stopping the moment a payment webhook confirms it's paid.

n8n

Groq LLM

Google Sheets

Email

1 Executive Summary

Chasing unpaid invoices manually means someone has to remember who owes what, decide how firmly to word each follow-up, and keep track of who's already been reminded. This workflow automates all of that: a rule-based scheduler decides exactly when each client is due for a reminder and how urgent it should sound, Groq drafts the actual wording, and every send is logged so nobody gets double-reminded or missed. The moment a payment comes in through the webhook, that client drops out of the reminder cycle automatically.

2 Key Metrics

Reminder Trigger	Daily schedule (9:22 AM) reading every row of a Google Sheets Invoices tab
Reminder Logic	Rule-based tiers: upcoming, due today, first/second reminder, final notice
Email Drafting	A Groq-powered agent writes the message; the workflow adds the table and payment button
Payment Webhook	A separate endpoint marks an invoice paid and stops future reminders for it
Audit Trail	Every reminder sent is appended to an Activity Log tab, plus the invoice row itself
Team Visibility	A daily summary totals reminders sent, amounts outstanding and urgency breakdown
Rate Limiting	Each reminder tier requires a minimum number of days since the last reminder

5

REMINDER TIERS

9:22 AM

DAILY RUN TIME

0

DUPLICATE REMINDERS

3 Business Value

- ✓ **Nobody has to remember to chase anyone** — the ledger is checked every single day, automatically, at the same time.
- ✓ **Reminders get firmer as they need to** — tone escalates from a gentle heads-up to a final notice without a human deciding.
- ✓ **No double-reminding or awkward silence** — each tier only fires once enough days have passed since the last reminder.
- ✓ **Payments stop reminders instantly** — a payment page hitting the webhook drops the client out of the next day's run.

4 Architecture Overview

Two independent flows share one Google Sheets ledger: a daily scheduled cycle, and an always-on payment webhook.

FLOW	TRIGGER	PURPOSE
Daily Reminder Cycle	Schedule trigger, once a day	Reads every unpaid invoice, decides who needs a reminder, drafts and sends it, and reports to finance
Payment Webhook	Webhook, called by a payment page	Marks the matching invoice as paid, emails a confirmation, and removes it from future reminders

5 How It Works

Daily Reminder Cycle

- 1 A daily trigger starts the cycle; every row is pulled from the Invoices tab.
- 2 Paid invoices are skipped; days overdue and days since last reminder decide which tier applies.
- 3 A structured prompt (client, amount, dates, urgency) is assembled for each invoice needing a reminder.
- 4 Groq drafts a concise, professional email matching the tone to the urgency level.
- 5 The workflow adds the invoice-details table and payment button itself, then sends and logs it.

Payment Webhook

- 1 A webhook accepts a POST from the payment page with invoice number, amount and method.
- 2 The Invoices sheet is searched by invoice number to locate the exact row.
- 3 The row is updated with payment_status = paid, the date, amount and method.
- 4 The payment page receives a JSON success response.
- 5 The client is separately emailed a formatted payment confirmation as a receipt.

6 Reliability & Security Design

- ◆ **Payment link never AI-generated** — the workflow builds it itself from real invoice data, so it can never be wrong.
- ◆ **Placeholder stripping** — any stray [Your Name]-style placeholder the AI produces is actively removed before sending.
- ◆ **Rate-limited by design** — each tier requires a minimum number of days since the last reminder.
- ◆ **Payments stop reminders immediately** — the webhook updates payment_status the moment a payment lands.
- ◆ **Full send history** — every reminder is reflected on the invoice row and recorded in a separate Activity Log.
- ◆ **Tiered escalation** — urgency is calculated from days overdue, never guessed by the AI.

7 Setup Checklist

- ☒ Connect a Google Sheets credential with an Invoices tab and an Activity Log tab.
- ☒ Connect a Groq credential for the AI email-drafting agent.
- ☒ Replace the from-address placeholders in the reminder and confirmation email nodes.
- ☒ Set the real payment page URL so the Pay Invoice button links to your actual checkout.
- ☒ Activate the workflow and point your payment page's success callback at the webhook's Production URL.

8 Node-by-Node Map

Daily Cycle	Schedule Daily Check → Fetch Pending Invoices → Calculate Reminder Logic → AI Agent Draft Email
Format & Send	Format Email → Send Email Reminder → Update Reminder Status
Logging & Reporting	Create Activity Log → Generate Daily Summary → Send Summary to Finance
Payment Webhook	Webhook: Payment Received → Lookup Invoice → Update Payment Status → Send Confirmation

SUMMARY

Designed and built end-to-end in n8n, demonstrating rule-based scheduling logic, AI-assisted email drafting with guardrails, and a webhook-driven payment reconciliation loop.